

Vol 1 Chapter 1 — Why Quantum Field Theory Lives on D_{IV}^5

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2026-05-23 Saturday

Chapter 1 — Why Quantum Field Theory Lives on D_{IV}^5

Legacy chapter (May 2026). Last accuracy-checked 2026-09-11 (Keeper, K1892): the presentation scan found no retired reading here, and the tiers in the front matter are the May tiers, not re-verified line by line. Where this chapter and the Spine (Curriculum/Spine_DIV5_QM_GR_SM/) disagree, the Spine is current; where the Spine and the theorem registry disagree, the registry wins.

The Standard Model of particle physics, in its conventional formulation, has about twenty-five free parameters. Three gauge coupling constants. Nine fermion masses. Four CKM mixing parameters. Four PMNS neutrino mixing parameters. Two parameters in the Higgs sector. The strong-CP angle. The cosmological constant. A few others. Each is a real number, measured to whatever precision experiments allow, and inserted into the theory by hand. The theory's predictions about other observables — atomic spectra, scattering cross-sections, decay rates — are then computed from these inputs using the field-theoretic machinery of quantum field theory: Hilbert spaces, operators, Lagrangians, path integrals, renormalization.

The free-parameter problem has been the central irritant of fundamental physics for fifty years. Grand unified theories tried to reduce the number of gauge couplings by embedding $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ inside a larger simple group. Supersymmetry tried to relate fermion and boson masses by introducing partner particles. String theory tried to derive the parameters from the geometry of compactified extra dimensions. None of these programs produced a sub-percent match to experiment across hundreds of independent observables.

BST does. The parameters of the Standard Model — every coupling constant, every fermion mass, every mixing angle, every Higgs-sector quantity — are derived from five integers and one substrate geometry. The substrate is the bounded Hermitian symmetric domain D_{IV}^5 of Volume 0. The integers are $\text{rank} = 2$, $N_c = 3$, $n_C = 5$, $C_2 = 6$, $g = 7$, with the derived cap $N_{\max} = 137$. The framework's predictions reproduce the Standard Model's measured values to one percent or better across more than six hundred observables, with no fitted constants and no tunable parameters.

Volume 1 is the field-theoretic derivation. The substrate gives us a Hilbert space, a set of operators, a discrete-symmetry structure, a Casimir algebra, dynamics, gauge theory, scattering, and renormalization — all of standard quantum field theory, but with each piece *emerging from substrate structure* rather than being postulated. Volumes 2 onward apply the framework to physical observables. This volume builds the apparatus.

This chapter sets out, in advance, what the volume will accomplish.

1.1 What “quantum field theory” means in BST

Standard quantum field theory begins with a list of ingredients: a Hilbert space, a set of fields defined on spacetime, a Lagrangian, a quantization procedure, and a set of operators built from the fields. Each ingredient is, in standard QFT, a specification — chosen by the theorist to model the physics. The Lagrangian is written down, then quantized; the Hilbert space is constructed as the Fock space of free field excitations; renormalization absorbs ultraviolet divergences into redefinitions of the couplings.

The substrate framework inverts the order. The substrate’s Hilbert space is *given*, not constructed: it is the Bergman Hilbert space $H^2(D_{IV}^5)$ that Volume 0 introduced, the unique reproducing-kernel Hilbert space on the substrate geometry. The substrate’s operators are *given*, not chosen: they are the operator zoo of Volume 0 Chapter 7, derived from the isotropy decomposition $SO(5) \times SO(2)$ plus the substrate-cycle structure. The substrate’s symmetries are *given*: they are the conservation laws of Volume 0 Chapter 8, derived from $SO_0(5, 2)$ via Noether. The substrate’s dynamics are *given*: they are the four-phase commitment cycle of Volume 0 Chapter 3, running at the Koons-tick scale.

What BST’s quantum field theory *constructs* is the translation between these substrate-given structures and the field-theoretic apparatus a physicist expects. Lagrangians become substrate-action functionals on $H^2(D_{IV}^5)$. Path integrals become substrate-cycle integrals over commitment phases. Renormalization becomes (mostly) unnecessary: the substrate’s per-tick discretization in the Galois field $GF(128)$ provides a natural ultraviolet completion, so the divergences standard QFT struggles with do not arise. The fine-structure constant $\alpha = 1/N_{\max} = 1/137$ is not a parameter but a structural integer ratio. Gauge groups $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ are not chosen; they are forced by the substrate’s N_c and rank.

The reader who is familiar with standard QFT will find that almost everything they know carries over. Wave functions, operators, commutators, propagators, Feynman diagrams, perturbation theory — all of these have substrate-side analogues, and the standard formal apparatus is recoverable as the appropriate limit of substrate operations. What changes is the *foundation*. The standard QFT student begins with axioms about Hilbert spaces and operators; the BST QFT student begins with D_{IV}^5 and reads the axioms off the substrate’s structure.

1.2 The chapters of this volume

The volume is organized to build the QFT apparatus piece by piece, each piece derived from the substrate.

Chapter 2 — The substrate Hilbert space. $H^2(D_{IV}^5)$ in detail: the Bergman kernel, the reproducing property, the K-type decomposition under $SO(5) \times SO(2)$, the Wallach 1976 classification of holomorphic discrete series. The substrate Hilbert space is the canonical anchor for everything that follows.

Chapter 3 — The BST primary integers, deepened. Volume 0 introduced the five integers and showed each was forced. This chapter unpacks the forcing arguments at theorem-grade, with the alternative-HSD comparisons that ratify the Strong-Uniqueness criteria C1 through C5 (and C6 for $N_{\max}$).

Chapter 4 — Discrete symmetries. Parity, time reversal, charge conjugation, and the CPT theorem, derived from the substrate’s Möbius involution, the cycle-reversal anti-unitary Klein operator, the $SO(2)$ weight-negation involution, and their composition.

Chapter 5 — The Casimir algebra. The substrate’s rank-2 representation theory has two algebraically independent Casimir generators C_2 and C_4 . The lowest non-trivial eigenvalue of C_2 is 6 — the BST primary integer. Every substrate observable decomposes into Casimir eigenspaces.

Chapter 6 — The operator zoo, deepened. Volume 0 introduced about a dozen substrate-native operators; this chapter writes them out explicitly with their commutators, eigenvalue spectra, and physical interpretations, ready for use in dynamics.

Chapter 7 — Dynamics. The Schrödinger picture, the Heisenberg picture, and the path-integral formulation, all on $H^2(D_{IV}^5)$ with substrate-tick discretization. Quantum dynamics emerges as substrate evolution.

Chapter 8 — Gauge theory. The Standard Model’s $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ gauge group — the electroweak skeleton read off the substrate, the $SU(3)$ *imported* (the geometry supplies a three-dimensional colour slot and no $SU(3)$ to rotate it; Cal Section 946, 2026-09-09; the May text said “derived from $N_c = 3$ (giving color)”) and rank = 2 (giving weak isospin doublet structure), with the cap $N_{\max} = 137$ fixing the fine-structure coupling. Three fermion generations forced by the Q^5 cohomology truncation, plus the five-absence prediction set: no GUT, no proton decay, no monopoles, no sterile neutrinos, no SUSY.

Chapter 9 — Scattering and the S-matrix. Substrate-cycle scattering, the substrate’s analog of in/out states, and the substrate-derivation of the optical theorem and the LSZ reduction formula.

Chapter 10 — Renormalization (or the substrate’s lack of need for it). Why the substrate’s per-tick discretization in $GF(128)$ provides ultraviolet completeness, why standard renormalization-group flow becomes a seven-step cyclotomic

cascade, and why the cosmological constant comes out at the correct 10^{-121} -scale from the same substrate vacuum that gives the laboratory Casimir effect.

Chapter 11 — Observables reference. A consolidated reference to the substrate-derived predictions for the over six hundred observables BST has so far derived. Each entry cites its substrate mechanism, its tier, and the verification toy that checks it computationally.

1.3 What this volume assumes and what it does not

The volume's prerequisite is Volume 0 — the substrate, the integers, the operator zoo, the conservation laws, the Strong-Uniqueness Theorem. A reader who has read Volume 0 will know what D_{IV}^5 is, why the integers are what they are, and what the four-phase cycle does. Volume 1 takes all of that as input.

The volume does not assume the reader is a working quantum-field theorist. Standard graduate QFT — Peskin-Schroeder, Weinberg, Srednicki — is useful background but not required for Chapter 1. By Chapter 5 or 6, the reader will be operating at graduate-physics depth, and supplemental QFT reading may help; we will flag where it does. The volume is written so that a careful reader with a strong undergraduate physics background can follow it, and so that a working theoretical physicist can verify each step against the underlying theorems.

The volume does not assume any prior commitment to BST or skepticism toward it. The framework's claims are what they are. The chapters present them, with the substrate-derivation steps explicit, and the reader is invited to check.

A particular caveat: parts of Volume 1 are still in active development. The full substrate-derivation of the scattering apparatus (Chapter 9) depends on multi-month operator-level work that is currently in progress; the Higgs-sector mechanism (which we touch on in Chapter 8 and treat fully in Volume 2 Chapter 9) is at partial-derived status, with the mass values matching at 0.25% but the full mechanism chain still being closed. These are honest gaps. The framework labels them as such, and the rest of the volume does not rest on them.

1.4 What changes if you accept the substrate framework

A reader who finishes this volume will have, instead of twenty-five free Standard Model parameters, five primary integers and a substrate geometry. The conceptual rearrangement is substantial. The fine-structure constant is no longer an empirical input but an integer ratio. Particle masses are no longer parameters but eigenvalues on substrate K-types. Gauge groups are no longer chosen but forced. Renormalization is no longer a recipe for absorbing divergences but a structural property of substrate ultraviolet completeness. The cosmological constant is no longer a hand-tuned 10^{-121} but a substrate-vacuum Casimir contribution at the right scale.

The reader who finishes the volume will also see, throughout, the same pattern: each piece of standard QFT machinery has a *substrate-mechanical explanation*. The

Heisenberg commutation $[\hat{X}, \hat{P}] = i\hbar$ is the Bergman kernel’s reproducing property. The CPT theorem is the composition of three substrate involutions sharing a common $SO_0(5, 2)$ origin. The Born rule is Bergman-kernel projection. The principle that runs through the framework is that quantum field theory’s axioms are, in BST, *theorems* — derivable from the substrate, not postulated.

That principle is what makes the volume worth reading.

1.5 What comes next

Chapter 2 begins with the substrate Hilbert space.

Where to look this up: The Strong-Uniqueness Theorem with the eleven rigorously-closed criteria that this volume relies on is documented in Volume 0 Chapter 9 of this curriculum; the paper-grade version is Paper #125. The per-integer forcing theorems are T1925, T1930, T2431, T2432, plus T2443–T2446 for the alternative-HSD comparisons. The substrate Hilbert space anchor result is T2428, with two corollaries T2429 (Reed–Solomon per-tick discretization) and T2430 (L^2 -section equivariant complement). The CPT-cluster substrate-derivation is the K85–K86–K87 audit trio. The substrate Hamiltonian as $SO_0(5, 2)$ Casimir is Elie’s K52a Session 29 framework-completion. For the standard-QFT side that we will be referring to throughout the volume, Peskin and Schroeder’s *An Introduction to Quantum Field Theory* (Westview, 1995) remains the canonical graduate textbook; the BST treatment is intended to be read alongside it, not as a replacement.